



IILM UNIVERSITY, GREATER NOIDA

INTERNSHIP REPORT PRESENTATION

Mastercard

Cybersecurity Job Simulation

Virtual Work Experience Programme | Offered through Forage

Md Ayan Alam

Roll No. 25SCS1003000702 | B.Tech CSE

September 2026



**Md Ayan
Alam**

B.Tech – Computer Science & Engineering

ABOUT THE STUDENT

Candidate Profile



Roll Number

25SCS1003000702



Institute

IILM University, Greater Noida, U.P.



Programme

B.Tech CSE, Batch 2025–2029



Internship Domain

Cybersecurity – Security Awareness



Duration

September 2026

Mastercard, Forage & the Security Awareness Team

Mastercard is a global technology company in the payments industry, connecting consumers, financial institutions, merchants and governments across more than 200 countries and territories. Its Security Awareness Team works to reduce human-factor risk across the organisation through training, simulation and awareness campaigns. Forage partners with employers such as Mastercard to publish free, open-access virtual job simulations built from the real work those teams carry out.



Global Payments Network

Mastercard operates across 200+ countries and territories.



Security Awareness

Reducing human-factor risk through simulation and training.



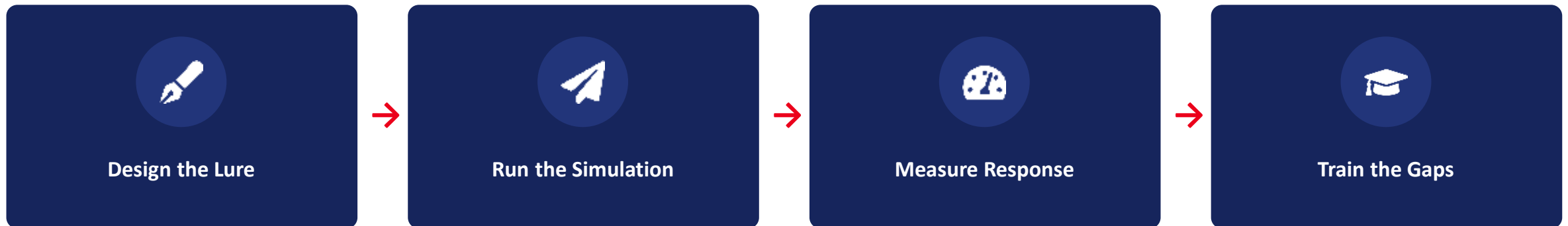
Real Workplace Tasks

Forage simulations are built from the team's actual work.

People, Not Firewalls, Are the Target

Phishing remains one of the leading causes of data breaches because it targets people rather than technology. Even organisations with strong technical controls stay exposed when employees cannot recognise a fraudulent message. Computer science students usually meet social engineering only as a definition — with no practice in building a realistic simulation, measuring how an organisation responds, or turning that data into training.

This simulation closed that gap by working through the security awareness cycle end to end:



What the Simulation Set Out to Achieve



Understand the Role

Learn what a security awareness function does day to day inside a large organisation.



Spot the Indicators

Study sender spoofing, urgency, pretexting and malicious links in real phishing mail.



Design a Simulation

Write a realistic phishing e-mail capable of testing employee awareness.



Interpret Results

Read click and report rates to find where the human-factor risk actually sits.



Recommend Training

Turn the findings into targeted awareness training for the groups at risk.



Earn the Credential

Complete every practical task and obtain the Certificate of Completion.

The Toolkit Behind the Simulation



Phishing

Social-engineering technique



Human-Factor Risk

The employee as attack surface



Pretexting

Lure and scenario design



Link & Sender Analysis

Spoofing indicators



Result Interpretation

Click and report rates



Risk Prioritisation

Departments at highest risk



Awareness Training

Targeted remediation



Professional Writing

Deliverables for a security team

The Security Awareness Cycle



Awareness Layer

Objectives, audience and acceptable risk thresholds



Design Layer

A simulated phishing e-mail with a realistic pretext



Delivery Layer

Controlled delivery to selected employee groups



Measurement Layer

Opens, clicks and reported attempts captured



Analysis Layer

Highest-risk departments, roles and behaviours identified



Training Layer

Targeted awareness training closes the loop

Two Practical Tasks, One Workflow

01

TASK

Design a Phishing Email Simulation

- Reviewed Mastercard's security awareness programme and its objectives.
- Studied the indicators that make a phishing message convincing.
- Designed a simulated phishing e-mail to test employee awareness.
- Submitted the deliverable and compared it against the model answer.

02

TASK

Interpret Phishing Simulation Results

- Analysed the reported results of the simulated campaign.
- Identified the departments and behaviours carrying the highest risk.
- Recommended targeted security awareness training for those groups.
- Presented the findings in the format a security team would use.

Each task was submitted in writing and then compared against a model answer prepared by the Mastercard team.

Skills & Capabilities Gained

- ✓ Ability to explain the role of a security awareness function and the human-factor risks it reduces
- ✓ Practical understanding of phishing and the indicators that identify a fraudulent message
- ✓ Capability to design a realistic phishing e-mail simulation for an organisation
- ✓ Skill to interpret simulation results and locate the groups and behaviours carrying most risk
- ✓ Ability to recommend targeted, evidence-based security awareness training
- ✓ Completion of both practical tasks and award of the Mastercard Certificate of Completion

CERTIFICATION

Successfully Completed



Programme

Cybersecurity Job Simulation



Issued By

Mastercard, through Forage



Date of Completion

20 September 2026



Tasks Completed

Phishing design & result analysis

Certificate of Completion



Inspiring and
empowering
future professionals

Md Ayan Alam Cybersecurity Job Simulation

Certificate of Completion
September 20th, 2026

Over the period of September 2026, Md Ayan Alam has completed practical tasks in:

Design a phishing email simulation
Interpret phishing simulation results

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Tom Brunskill".

Tom Brunskill
Co-Founder of Forage

Blockchain Verification Code: 8aaf506e4759467348d3d759 | Email Verification Code: 8aaf506e4759467348d3d759 | Issued by Forage



Thank You

Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation | Forage Virtual Work Experience

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